



Telephone interviews and etiquette



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TABLE OF CONTENTS

S.No	Topics	Pg no
1	Introduction	3
2	Telephone interview	4
3	Key feature of telephone interview	4
4	Objectives of telephone interview	4
5	Types of telephone interview	5
6	Importance of telephone interview	5
7	Telephone interview etiquette	6
8	Do's and Don'ts	7
9	Importance of telephone etiquette	7
10	Benefits of good telephone etiquette	8
11	Conclusion	8



TELEPHONE INTERVIEWS AND ETIQUETTE

Introduction

A telephone interview is an interview conducted over a phone call between an employer and a job applicant. It is usually the first stage of the recruitment process. Employers use telephone interviews to evaluate a candidate's communication skills, confidence, qualifications, and suitability for the job before inviting them for a face-to-face interview.

Telephone etiquette refers to the polite and professional behavior followed while speaking on the phone. It includes answering calls politely, speaking clearly, listening carefully, and showing respect to the other person. Good telephone etiquette creates a positive first impression and helps build professional relationships.





What is a Telephone Interview?

A telephone interview is a job interview conducted over the phone between an employer and a job applicant. It is usually the first stage of the hiring process, where employers assess a candidate's communication skills, confidence, qualifications, and suitability for the job.

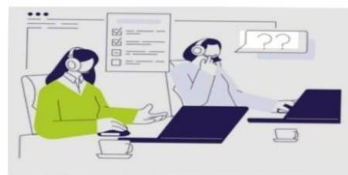
Unlike face-to-face interviews, telephone interviews rely only on verbal communication. Therefore, candidates should speak clearly, listen carefully, and answer questions confidently.

Key Features of a Telephone Interview

- Conducted over a phone call.
- Used as the first stage of recruitment.
- Saves time and travel costs.
- Evaluates communication and listening skills.
- Helps employers shortlist suitable candidates.

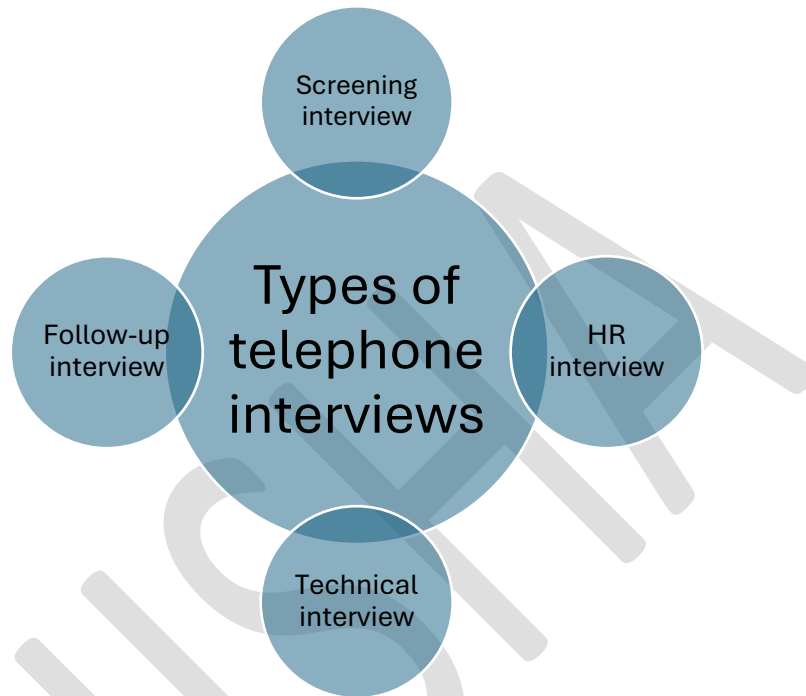
Objectives of a Telephone Interview

- To screen job applicants.
- To evaluate communication skills.
- To assess confidence and professionalism.
- To verify qualifications and experience.
- To shortlist candidates for the next interview round.





Types of Telephone Interviews



Importance of Telephone Interviews

Telephone interviews are widely used because they help employers quickly identify suitable candidates. They also reduce travel costs and save valuable time for both employers and applicants.

A successful telephone interview creates a positive impression and increases the candidate's chances of moving to the next stage of the selection process.





Telephone Interview Etiquette

Good telephone etiquette is important during every interview.

Before the Call

- Be available 10–15 minutes before the scheduled time.
- Keep your phone on silent mode except for the interview call.
- Ensure there are no distractions.

During the Call

- Answer politely.
- Introduce yourself clearly.
- Speak slowly and confidently.
- Listen carefully before answering.
- Avoid interrupting the interviewer.
- Be honest and professional.
- Maintain a positive tone.

After the Call

- Thank the interviewer for their time.
- Express your interest in the position.
- Follow up with a thank-you email if appropriate.





Do's and Don'ts

Do's	Don'ts
Be on time.	Don't be late.
Speak clearly.	Don't speak too fast.
Listen carefully.	Don't interrupt the interviewer.
Be polite and confident.	Don't use rude words.
Keep your phone charged.	Don't answer in noisy place.
Keep your resume ready.	Don't eat during the interview.
Answer honestly.	Don't give false information.
Thank the interviewer.	Don't end the call suddenly.



Importance of Telephone Etiquette

- Creates a good first impression.
- Builds confidence.
- Improves communication.
- Shows professionalism.
- Helps build good relationships.
- Increases the chances of success.



Benefits of Good Telephone Etiquette

- Creates a positive first impression.
- Improves communication skills.
- Builds confidence.
- Demonstrates professionalism.
- Reduces misunderstandings.
- Increases the chances of getting selected.
- Helps build good professional relationships.

Conclusion

Telephone interviews have become an important part of the recruitment process. They allow employers to assess candidates efficiently while giving applicants an opportunity to demonstrate their communication skills and confidence. By preparing well and following proper telephone etiquette, candidates can make a positive impression and improve their chances of success. Good telephone manners are valuable not only during interviews but also in everyday professional communication.

